



PHYSICAL STAMINA

A Healthy and Balanced Diet

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What makes it difficult to eat healthily?

- ☐ Shortage of time either to buy food, or to take a break during the working day to eat.
- ☐ Lack the energy needed to prepare food particularly at the end of the day.
- ☐ Insufficient knowledge of nutrition or food preparation.
- ☐ Crave certain foods such as sugar, processed foods, fizzy drinks or alcohol
- ☐ Resistant to trying new foods.

How does that affect you?

- ☐ Lack of energy
- ☐ Guilt
- ☐ Tiredness
- ☐ Weight gain
- ☐ Low self-esteem
- ☐ Low mood
- ☐ Poor sleep
- ☐ Impaired cognitive function such as poor memory, difficulty concentrating or short attention span.

Key Principles of Healthy Eating



CALORIE INTAKE

Appropriate personal daily calorie intake, taking age and exercise level into account.



MACRONUTRIENTS

Balance Macronutrients:
Fats 20-35%, Proteins 10-35%,
Carbohydrates 45-65%.



CORRECT PORTION SIZES

Fist: rice, pasta, veg, fruit. **Palm:** meat, fish, poultry. **Handful:** nuts, raisins.
Index finger: cheese, peanut butter.
Fingertip: mayo, oil, butter, sugar.



LIMIT OR ELIMINATE

Smoking, alcohol, refined sugars (e.g. coke, confectionary), salt, saturated fats, processed foods.



TRY TO INCLUDE

5-7 portions of fruit & veg/day, base meals on starchy complex carbohydrates (e.g. wholegrain rice), include some dairy alternatives, eat pulses, beans, nuts, eggs, 2 portions fish, lean meat every week.



MICRONUTRIENTS

Incorporate Essential Micronutrients: Vitamins -B complex (especially B12 if vegetarian/vegan), A, C, D, E, K. Minerals -Iron, Zinc, Iodine, Calcium, Selenium, Phosphorous



IMPROVE GUT HEALTH

And hence cognitive function, immune function, digestion and heart health, by eating complex carbohydrates (wholegrains, legumes, fruit & veg), and natural yogurt (prebiotics & probiotics).



COVID/LONG-COVID

If suffering from Covid/Long-covid, increase intake of Vitamin C, Selenium, Turmeric, Curcumin, and Glutathione. Limit alcohol, introduce moderate exercise gradually (weights & cardio), get restorative sleep.

Lifestyle Changes to Achieve Healthy Eating



1

MEAL PLAN

Plan and buy (online) for a number of days at a time to reduce dependence on takeaways, ready meals, meals out.



2

BATCH COOK

Batch cook where possible and freeze for another day.



3

EQUIP

Invest in kitchen equipment - food processors/blenders, scales, non-stick pans.



4

RESEARCH

Use time-saving, and diversified healthy recipes.



5

ELIMINATE

Eliminate tempting foods at home and make healthy snacks available (trail mix, carrot sticks & houmous, fruit).



6

LIMIT

Adopt time-restricted eating. Limit daily food intake to an 8-10 hr window (ideally), up to 12 hrs maximum.



7

HYDRATE

Drink water when you feel hungry – you may just be thirsty.

Healthy Eating Resources

Action Plan



Using these resources, log your daily nutrient intake over 2-4 days (to include one weekend day) using either an APP or by manually recording.



Also log your energy levels, mood and daily eating window.



Critically evaluate your log and adjust to incorporate healthy foods, and appropriate daily calorie intake.

4 TOP APPS

For tracking your daily nutritional intake and exercise, nutrition advice and support, and goal setting



LIFESUM
lifesum.com



LOSE IT!
loseit.com



ZOE
zoe.com
for personalised
nutrition



MYFITNESSPAL
myfitnesspal.com

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EXERCISE 1

Do you meet the recommended daily portions?

Use the template below to log your food intake on a typical day and then categorise them into the 4 food groups as shown in the example. Compare your total portions consumed of each food group with the recommended portions and over the next few weeks, try to adjust your diet to reflect the recommendations.

MEAL		 FRUIT & VEGETABLES	 STARCHY FOODS	 PROTEIN FOODS	 DAIRY / ALTERNATIVES
Breakfast	Porridge with milk, kiwi, handful of nuts	☒ ☐ ☐	☒ ☐ ☐	☒ ☐ ☐	☒ ☐ ☐
Morning Snack	Carrot sticks	☒ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐
Lunch	Prawns in wholemeal bread. Pot of natural yogurt, pomegranate seeds added	☒ ☐ ☐	☒ ☐ ☐	☒ ☒ ☐	☒ ☐ ☐
Afternoon snack	Banana	☒ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐
Evening meal	Salmon, broccoli, leeks, wholegrain rice. Stewed apple	☒ ☒ ☒	☒ ☐ ☐	☒ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐
Milk in tea/ coffee (half portion)		☐ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐	☐ ☐ ☐	☒ ☐ ☐
TOTAL PORTIONS PER DAY		7	3	4	3

Recommended daily portions

 FRUIT & VEGETABLES At least 5 portions	 STARCHY FOODS 3-4 portions	 PROTEIN FOODS 2-3 portions	 DAIRY / ALTERNATIVES 2-3 portions	 UNSATURATED OILS & SPREADS Small amounts
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A Healthy and Balanced Diet



EXERCISE 2

Keep a food diary

This exercise takes a more detailed look at your intake of macro and micro-nutrients and eating pattern, helping you to assess your current eating habits, the impact this has on your mood and energy levels, and highlights areas you can tackle to improve your nutrition and well-being.

1

LOG YOUR CURRENT FOOD INTAKE

Using one of these Nutrition Apps, log your current food intake over 3-4 days, one of which should include a weekend day. You should try not to alter your food choices or eating pattern at this stage.

At the same time, log your energy levels, mood and eating window.

You should also be able to assess your ideal daily calorie intake with the APP. If not, then use the one provided by freedieting.com/calorie-calculator.



2

REVIEW YOUR DIARY –

- Are you eating too much processed food, fats, sugars?
- Are you snacking into the evening?
- Perhaps you are missing meals and then over-eating at the next meal, or having unhealthy snacks throughout the day?
- How is your balance of Fats: Carbohydrates: Proteins?
- Are you getting the right micronutrients and drinking enough water?
- Can you see a connection between feeling tired or irritable and the types of food you are eating?

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3

SET YOURSELF A GOAL

Having critically evaluated this diary, set yourself a goal, such as to reduce unhealthy snacking &/or replace it with healthy snacks, to have regular mealtimes, eat more fruit and vegetables, and then make the required adjustments to your diet.

Don't try to change too much at once, it will increase your chance of success if you focus on 1-2 goals.

4

MAKE ADJUSTMENTS

With your goal in mind, make adjustments to your diet to make healthier food choices at the required daily calorie level, using the APP.

Remember to keep a log of your mood, energy levels and eating window.

After 3-4 weeks complete another food/mood/energy diary and see the results!

Nutritional Information



FREEDIETING

Use the personal calorie intake calculator to assess appropriate daily calories (different scales may produce slightly different results)

freedieting.com/calorie-calculator



NHS EATWELL PLATE

The NHS Eatwell Plate gives an overview of how many portions of each food group (Fats, Protein, Carbohydrates) you should aim to eat every day

gov.uk/government/publications/the-eatwell-guide

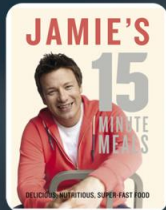


GET PORTION WISE!

Portion sizes can be found on the British Nutrition Foundation's website

nutrition.org.uk/putting-it-into-practice/balancing-the-diet/get-portion-wise

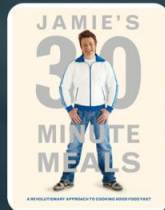
Recipe and Meal Planning



15 MINUTE MEALS

Time-saving recipes

[Jamie Oliver](#)



30 MINUTE MEALS

Time-saving recipes

[Jamie Oliver](#)



PAPRIKA

Recipes, nutritional tracking, meal plans & shopping lists

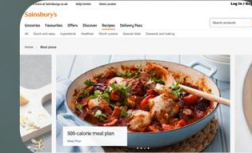
paprikaapp.com



MEALIME

Recipes, nutritional tracking, meal plans & shopping lists

mealime.com



SAINSBURY'S ONLINE

Nutritional Information and Meal planning ideas

recipes.sainsburys.co.uk/meal-plans



MEDITERRANEAN DIET

Balancing Macronutrients (Fats, Proteins, Carbohydrates)

healthline.com/nutrition/mediterranean-diet-meal-plan

Healthy Recipes to get you started



BIRCHER MUESLI (1 Serving)

Premix and keep in the fridge overnight.

- 125g rolled oats
- 1 green apple, chopped
- 1 pinch cinnamon
- 2 tablespoons natural Greek yogurt
- 25g sultanas
- 1 tablespoon honey (preferably raw)
- 150ml semi-skimmed milk

473kcal	
Carbohydrates	85g
Protein	13g
Fat	9g
Fibre	8.25g

High in: Fibre, potassium, calcium, phosphorus, magnesium, selenium, iodine, vitamin A, vitamin C



BREAKFAST IN A GLASS (1 Serving)

Blend ingredients and store in the fridge or drink directly.

- 1 small banana
- 1 pear
- 100ml semi-skimmed milk
- 40g natural Greek yogurt
- ½ tablespoon chia seeds
- ½ tablespoon sunflower seeds or milled flaxseed
- 1 tablespoon unsalted peanut butter

427kcal	
Carbohydrates	184 kcal / 46g
Protein	58 kcal / 14.5g
Fat	186 kcal / 20.5g
Fibre	10g

High in: potassium, calcium, phosphorus, magnesium, iron, zinc, iodine, vit E, vit C, folate, biotin